

Notification of New JETRO Regional and Analysis Reports (August 27, 2026 Issue)

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Thank you for using JETRO Members Service.

We are pleased to provide you with information on new regional and analysis reports that JETRO produces from its unique perspective on political and economic trends in major countries and regions worldwide. We hope you will find these reports useful.

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[Special Feature] Korean Companies' Overseas Expansion: Current Status and New Challenges <Additional Articles>

Due to US-China tensions, rising production costs and oversupply in China, and improved competitiveness of Chinese companies, Korean direct investment in China has declined sharply, and Korean companies' China business has become increasingly challenging. Meanwhile, direct investment in the US has surged due to US industrial policy, but the outlook remains uncertain with the start of the second Trump administration. Korean companies are also showing strong interest in Vietnam as the leading "China Plus One" destination, while direct investment in Indonesia, Southeast Asia's largest economy, is also increasing. Furthermore, major Korean companies are actively expanding operations in India, a major country expected to achieve high economic growth. This special feature clarifies the state of Korean companies' overseas expansion.

<Additional Articles>

◇Korean Companies' US Investment (4) Korean Companies Capturing Power Infrastructure Demand

◇Korean Companies' US Investment (5) Korean Companies Joining US Critical Minerals Supply Chains

◇Korean Companies' US Investment (6) What Korean Companies' US Investment Tells Us

[Special Feature] Business Cases in Africa <Additional Articles>

In Africa, diverse business opportunities are emerging not only for major companies with networks and financial resources, but also for startups with cutting-edge technology and small and medium-sized enterprises in various fields. Additionally, diverse approaches are possible for each country, such as collaborations with third-country companies and local companies that have established track records. This special feature has introduced African business specifically, including developments around the 9th Tokyo International Conference on African Development (TICAD9) in fiscal years 2024-2025. In fiscal year

2026, with an eye toward the next TICAD10, this feature will cover a wide range of business cases involving Japanese companies and local companies, centered on company interviews, to explore new business opportunities emerging locally, possibilities for cooperation, and hints for business expansion.

<Additional Articles>

■ Japanese Company Cases – Manufacturing Sector's African Expansion

◇ Komatsu Expands Construction and Mining Machinery Throughout Africa

■ Japanese Company Cases – African Expansion from Across Japan

◇ From Gunma to Africa: Partnership Coordination and Internal Structure Development Are Essential

[Special Feature] Turbulent Middle East Situation: Impact and Outlook for Middle Eastern Countries <Additional Articles>

With the destabilization of the Middle East situation, the business environment surrounding companies operating in the region is undergoing significant change. This special feature tracks the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region, following recent trends in logistics and trade and various industries, as well as company initiatives, while also investigating and analyzing government responses and economic policies according to the situation. Through these efforts, this feature will comprehensively clarify geopolitical risks and new market opportunities in the MENA region, introducing a wide range of information to support Japanese companies' future Middle East business.

<Additional Articles>

◇ MENA Major Port Trends (1) Gulf States Shaken by Strait of Hormuz Crisis

◇ Impact of Deteriorating Middle East Situation on International Aviation Networks (2) Cargo Volume in Gulf Region Plummets

[Special Feature] Universities Producing Highly Skilled Foreign Talent: At the Forefront <Additional Articles>

In recent years, Japan's talent recruitment market continues to favor job seekers. Particularly acute is the shortage of science and engineering talent, with companies increasingly looking to foreign workers. On the other hand, approximately 70% of domestic international students specialize in humanities, making science and engineering talent scarce. Against this backdrop, interest is also rising in international students studying science and engineering in English and science and engineering talent enrolled in overseas universities. Additionally, more companies are seeking to hire overseas university students who study Japanese, regardless of their major. This special feature presents distinctive curricula, employment status with Japanese companies, and messages to companies based on interviews with promising domestic and international universities that

produce science and engineering talent and Japanese language learners interested in working in Japan.

<Additional Articles>

◇SRM University India: Cultivating Immediately Productive Engineers Through Japan-Focused Employment Program

[Special Feature] Maintaining the Free Trade System in an Era Where High Risk Becomes the Norm <Additional Articles>

As various risks, including geopolitical risks, have become normalized at high levels, since the start of 2026, deterioration in the Middle East situation has...